THEATRE

Playing *In The Capital*

*The **Mahindra Excellence in Theatre Awards** have announced their top 10 nominated plays which will be staged in New Delhi*



FIRST ACT Scenes from *Chandaa Bedni* and (inset) *Be-Loved...*

The NCPA Soulful Blues Festival is set to return in 2025, bigger and better than ever. Expanding to three electrifying nights, the festival brings internationally acclaimed blues legends, some of whom are making their India debut, to Mumbai's National Centre for the Performing Arts (NCPA) from March 14 to 16.

"The blues, although a familiar genre, was still relatively new territory for the NCPA," says Farrahnaz Irani, general manager– international music at NCPA. "We started on a smaller scale, but after curating two powerhouse vocalists who had audiences on their feet, we knew we had gotten it right. We were confident about growing the festival and tapping the right artistes."

Opening the festival is Alvon Johnson. A dynamic performer, he blends powerful guitar work with an infectious stage presence. "Alvon will have audiences dancing in no time," says Irani. "He brings pure joy and unbridled emotion, and will set the perfect tone for the festival."

Day two features Thornetta Davis, a 10-time Blues Music Awards nominee and winner of the 2023 Best Soul/Blues Artist Female award. With gospel-infused storytelling and a voice filled with raw emotion, she

MUSIC

GOT THE BLUES

***The Soulful Blues Festival** at the NCPA, Mumbai, is bringing major international performers to India*

